REVIEW – III · FINAL REPORT

Final Demonstration and Innovation

GraphRAG-Powered Cyber Threat Intelligence Platform: A Multi-Model NoSQL Approach

Deliverable	Review – III (10 marks): final demonstration and innovation
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Deliverables covered

Complete working system — Sections 4–8; source in backend/ and frontend/

Performance evaluation — Section 9: SLOs, 1×–200× scalability, index ablations, ANN recall, load, LLM latency

Final report — this document

User manual — separate document: User_Manual_GraphRAG_CTI_Platform.pdf

Presentation and demo — slide deck and demo runbook in review3/

Contents

Section	Page
1. Abstract	3
2. Introduction	3
3. Background and Related Work	4
4. System Architecture	6
5. Data Model	7
6. Implementation	9
7. Innovation and Technical Complexity	15
8. Testing and Validation	16
9. Performance Evaluation	19
10. Requirement Traceability	26
11. Limitations and Future Work	26
12. Conclusion	27
References	28
Appendix A. Reproducing the Results	29

Figures (diagrams and charts) and **tables** are numbered in order of appearance. All measured values in Sections 8 and 9 are generated from the JSON result files in `review3/performance/`, produced by `make eval` and `make bench` on 2026-10-25.

1. Abstract

Cyber threat intelligence (CTI) is polyglot data. Relationships between threat actors, campaigns, malware and infrastructure form a graph; analyst reports are schema-variable documents; active indicators of compromise (IOCs) need millisecond lookups that expire on time; and analysts ask questions in natural language that need semantic recall. This project delivers a working CTI workstation that gives each workload its natural engine — Neo4j for the threat graph, MongoDB for reports, Redis for the IOC blocklist and Qdrant for report embeddings — and adds a GraphRAG layer that retrieves evidence from all four stores before a locally hosted LLM writes an answer in which every sentence must cite a graph edge, a passage, a report or an IOC state.

Review III completes and evaluates the system. The platform ingests STIX 2.1 bundles and free-text reports, enforces Traffic Light Protocol (TLP) clearance on every read path, serves a fail-closed enforcement API to firewalls and EDR tools, and records every answer for replay. On the six acceptance questions it recalls 100% of the required graph facts and source reports; with the default `llama3.2:3b` model the GraphRAG end-to-end p95 is **9.5 s** against a 15 s target (down from 52.3 s in September). A new benchmark harness scales the corpus from 1× to 200× (15,012 nodes, 2,400 reports) and ablates the indexes of each store. It exposed four scalability defects — linear entity linking, an unbounded traversal with unindexed node lookups, a whole-graph join on ingest and a thread-safety bug under concurrent load — whose fixes cut GraphRAG retrieval p95 at 200× from **14.7 s** to **185 ms** and keep every store-level query within its service level. Finally, the four databases were moved to their vendors' own cloud services — Neo4j AuraDB, MongoDB Atlas, Redis Cloud and Qdrant Cloud — and loaded with real public threat intelligence (MITRE ATT&CK v20.0, abuse.ch Feodo Tracker and Emerging Threats): 2,118 graph nodes, 18,478 relationships, 249 reports and 515 live blocked IPs. On the hosted databases all 16 integration tests pass, GraphRAG still recalls 100% of the gold evidence, and an API request from a real botnet C2 address is refused and logged with an automatic expiry.

Keywords: cyber threat intelligence, polyglot persistence, NoSQL, graph database, vector search, retrieval-augmented generation, GraphRAG, performance evaluation.

2. Introduction

2.1 Problem

Security operations centres ask relational and semantic questions: which actors share command-and-control (C2) infrastructure, which campaigns reuse a commodity tool, which reports resemble a new phishing lure, and whether an indicator on the blocklist is still live. A single storage engine serves these workloads poorly [8], [9]: path queries become application-side joins in a document store, report bodies strain a graph store, and neither offers per-key expiry or approximate nearest-neighbour

search. Retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) over CTI adds a second risk: a language model can produce fluent attributions that no stored evidence supports [21], [23].

2.2 Objectives

- **O1** Ingest STIX 2.1 bundles and free-text reports consistently into all four stores.
- **O2** Answer multi-hop graph questions (shared infrastructure, shared tooling, common victims) natively in Neo4j.
- **O3** Serve full, schema-variable reports from MongoDB with TLP-based access control.
- **O4** Maintain a hot IOC blocklist in Redis with per-key TTL and a fail-closed enforcement API.
- **O5** Answer natural-language questions with GraphRAG on a local LLM, with every sentence cited and auditable.
- **O6** Demonstrate that the design meets its latency targets and scales, with reproducible measurements.

2.3 What Review III adds

Review I fixed the design and Review II delivered the first working build. This review closes the remaining gaps recorded in the progress report and evaluates the system as the rubric asks: a complete system with an analyst console of eight pages and 36 API endpoints; a performance evaluation covering query latency, scalability, indexing and benchmarking; and the documentation set (this report, a user manual, slides and a demo runbook). The main engineering contributions of this review are:

- a **prompt budget** and model choice that bring GraphRAG p95 from 52.3 s to 9.5 s, meeting NFR2 on a laptop;
- a **groundedness-gate fix** that stops valid citations written in variant forms from being discarded;
- a **benchmark harness** (`make bench`) for 1×–200× corpus scaling, index ablations, ANN recall and API load, which found **four scalability defects**, all fixed and re-measured;
- **16 integration tests**, an evaluation gate and **continuous integration** that run the whole stack on every push;
- a **hosted deployment** on the four vendors' cloud services, loaded with **real public threat intelligence**, and an **IP gate** that refuses API requests from blocklisted addresses and logs each refusal with a TTL.

3. Background and Related Work

Threat intelligence and sharing. Technical CTI — indicators, malware artefacts and procedures — is what automated defences consume, and its value lies in correlation rather than lookup [1], [2], [6].

STIX 2.1 already models CTI as a graph of objects and relationships [3], and ATT&CK gives a shared vocabulary of techniques [4]. MISP excels at disseminating events [5], [29] and OpenCTI offers a graph-backed product [16], but neither treats TTL-based enforcement, narrative similarity search and cited question answering as co-equal planes.

Polyglot persistence. “One size fits all” no longer holds for data management [8]; the NoSQL families each optimise a different access pattern and trade consistency guarantees accordingly [9]–[11]. Graph databases make multi-hop traversal a local operation through index-free adjacency [12], [26], and cybersecurity knowledge graphs have been built from reports and alerts [13]–[15]. Document stores keep heterogeneous reports without migrations [17]; key–value stores give constant-time lookups with native expiry [18]; and vector databases answer approximate k-NN queries with graph-based indexes such as HNSW [19], [20], [30].

From RAG to GraphRAG. RAG grounds generation in retrieved passages [21], [22], but passage retrieval alone cannot answer path questions. GraphRAG combines graph traversal with retrieval [23]–[25]; evaluation work stresses that answers must be faithful to their context [37] and that long, unprioritised contexts degrade model behaviour [36]. Benchmarks for serving systems [33], graph databases [34] and ANN indexes [35] motivate the measurement method in Section 9.

Capability	MISP	OpenCTI	Vanilla RAG	This platform
Multi-hop graph queries	limited	yes	no	yes (Neo4j)
Schema-variable reports	events	yes	passages	yes (MongoDB)
Per-key IOC expiry + enforcement API	no	no	no	yes (Redis, fail-closed)
Semantic search with payload filters	no	limited	yes	yes (Qdrant)
Cited natural-language answers	no	no	uncited	every sentence cited
Replay of an answer against the stores	no	no	no	yes
Runs fully offline (local LLM)	n/a	n/a	varies	yes

Table 1. Positioning against existing CTI platforms and plain RAG (Review I gaps G1–G5).

4. System Architecture

The implemented architecture matches the Review I design (Figure 1). A React console and downstream enforcement consumers are the only clients. A FastAPI service owns authentication, TLP policy, ingest, GraphRAG orchestration, audit and operations. Four NoSQL engines sit behind it, each with a closed set of operations, and a locally hosted LLM is called only by the GraphRAG orchestrator.

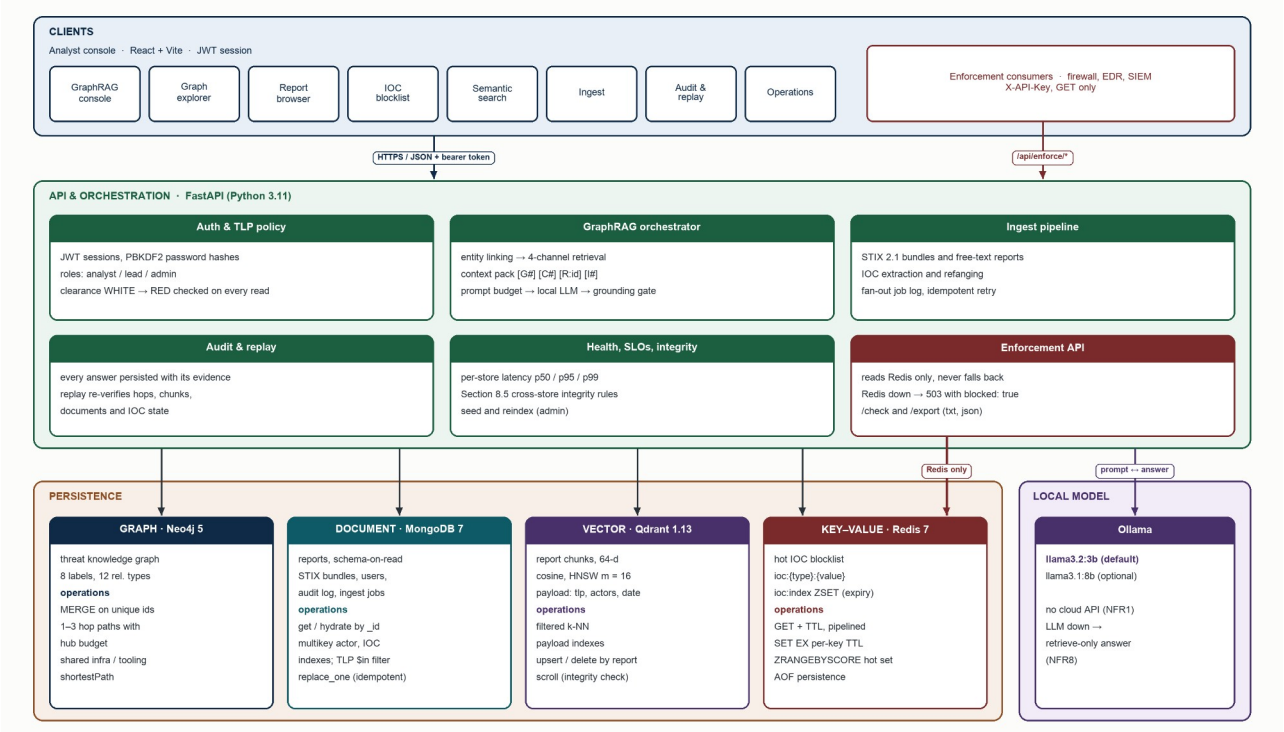


Figure 1. Implemented architecture: clients, API and orchestration, four NoSQL stores and the local model.

Store	Owns	Operations used	Why not another store
Neo4j 5	threat knowledge graph (8 labels, 12 relationship types)	MERGE by unique id; 1–3 hop paths with a hub budget; shortestPath	joins across documents are application code; Redis and Qdrant have no traversal
MongoDB 7	reports, STIX bundles, users, audit log, ingest jobs	get / hydrate by _id; multikey indexes on actors and IOCs; TLP $in filter	a graph node cannot hold report bodies with arbitrary nested fields
Redis 7	hot IOC blocklist	GET + TTL pipelined; SET EX; sorted-set expiry index	only Redis gives O(1) lookup with native per-key expiry
Qdrant 1.13	report chunk embeddings	filtered k-NN (HNSW, cosine); payload indexes	no other store offers ANN search with payload filters

Table 2. Responsibilities and closed operation set of each store.

Three keys join the stores (Figures 2 and 3): a report's `_id` in MongoDB is the `id` of its `Report` node and the `report_id` in every Qdrant point payload; and an indicator's `(type, value)` is both an `Indicator` node key and the Redis key `ioc:{type}:{value}`. These joins are verified by the integrity check in Section 5.3.

5. Data Model

5.1 Threat knowledge graph

Figure 2 shows the property graph as implemented. Identifiers are unique per label (constraints), commodity tools such as Mimikatz and Cobalt Strike are deliberately shared nodes, and `Indicator` nodes persist after their Redis key expires so that history and enforcement can disagree — the basis of use case UC4. The seed corpus loads 87 nodes and 162 relationships.

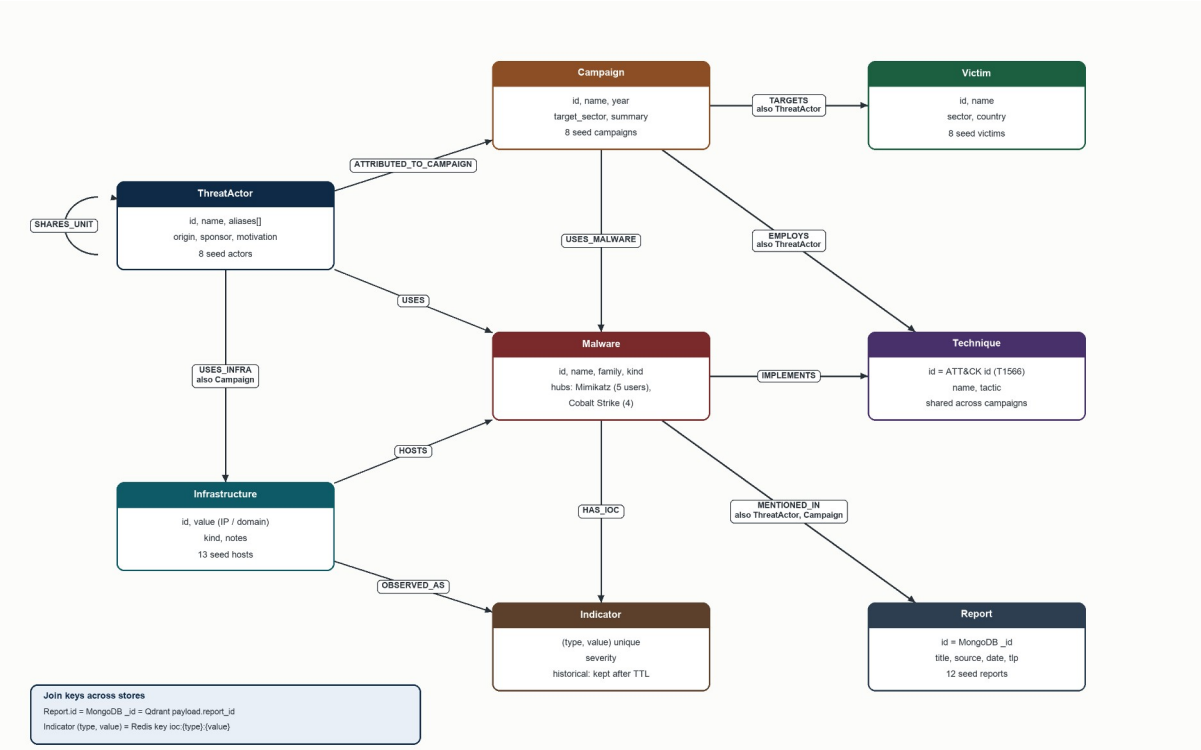


Figure 2. Graph schema (Neo4j): labels, key properties and relationship types.

5.2 Document, vector and key–value schemas

Reports share a small core envelope and diverge in report-specific fields (`attribution`, `build_pipeline`, `ics_protocols`), stored without migrations. Each report body is split into chunks of at most 420 characters; each chunk is a Qdrant point whose payload carries the fields that filters need. The Redis plane holds one string key per live IOC, expiring with `EX`, plus a sorted set scored by expiry time for the hot-set view.

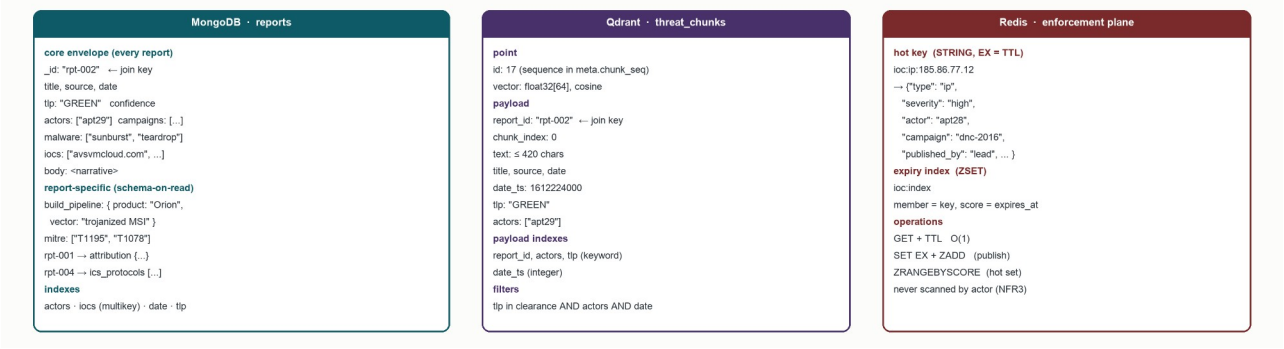


Figure 3. Document (MongoDB), vector (Qdrant) and key–value (Redis) schemas with their indexes.

5.3 Indexes, constraints and cross-store integrity

Store	Index or constraint	Serves
Neo4j	unique id on ThreatActor, Campaign, Malware, Infrastructure, Technique, Victim, Report; unique (type, value) on Indicator; range indexes on Infrastructure.value, Indicator.value, Indicator.id	MERGE during ingest; id lookups (index seek); IOC → graph lookups
MongoDB	reports: actors, iocs (multikey), date (desc), tlp; audit_log.ts; ingest_jobs.created_at; users.username (unique)	TLP-filtered listing; IOC history (UC4); newest-first views
Qdrant	HNSW (m = 16, ef_construct = 100); keyword payload indexes report_id, actors, tlp; integer date_ts	filtered k-NN; delete chunks of a report
Redis	key ioc:{type}:{value}; ZSET ioc:index	O(1) enforcement lookup; hot set and expiry listing

Table 3. Indexes and constraints (schema version 2, created at start-up by ensure_schema).

Integrity rule (Section 8.5 of Review I)	Kind	Effect if violated
Every MongoDB report has a Report node	hard	GraphRAG would cite a report with no graph context
Every Report node has a MongoDB document	hard	hydration fails
Every Qdrant point.report_id exists in MongoDB	hard	orphan chunks; GraphRAG refuses them
Every live Redis IOC traces to an Indicator node or a report	informational	operators may publish new IOCs (FR12)
Every MongoDB report has chunks in Qdrant	informational	report not reachable by semantic search

Table 4. Cross-store integrity rules checked by GET /api/admin/integrity and by the evaluation gate.

6. Implementation

6.1 Codebase

Part	Contents	Size
backend/app	FastAPI API, store clients, Cypher library, ingest, GraphRAG, security, metrics, seed corpus	3,643 lines of Python
backend/scripts	evaluation gate (evaluate.py) and benchmark harness (benchmark.py)	1,227 lines
backend/tests	18 unit tests and 16 integration tests	425 lines
frontend/src	React + Vite analyst console, 8 pages and 6 shared components	2,045 lines
deployment	docker-compose.yml (stores, app and llm profiles), docker-compose.bench.yml, Makefile, CI workflow	—

Table 5. Code organisation.

6.2 Ingest pipeline (FR1)

An ingest job turns a STIX bundle or a free-text report into a plan — graph nodes and edges, report documents and indicators — and executes it against Neo4j, MongoDB, Qdrant and optionally Redis in that order (Figure 4). STIX objects are merged into existing nodes by name or alias, relationship types are mapped onto the graph vocabulary (for example `attributed-to` is reversed into `ATTRIBUTED_TO_CAMPAIGN`), TLP comes from marking definitions, and indicator `valid_until` becomes the Redis TTL. Free text is linked to graph entities, and defanged IOCs such as `hxxp://evil[.]com` are refanged before extraction. There is no distributed transaction: each step is idempotent and recorded in `ingest_jobs`, so a failed job resumes from the first step that did not finish, and Qdrant refuses to index a document whose `Report` node is missing.

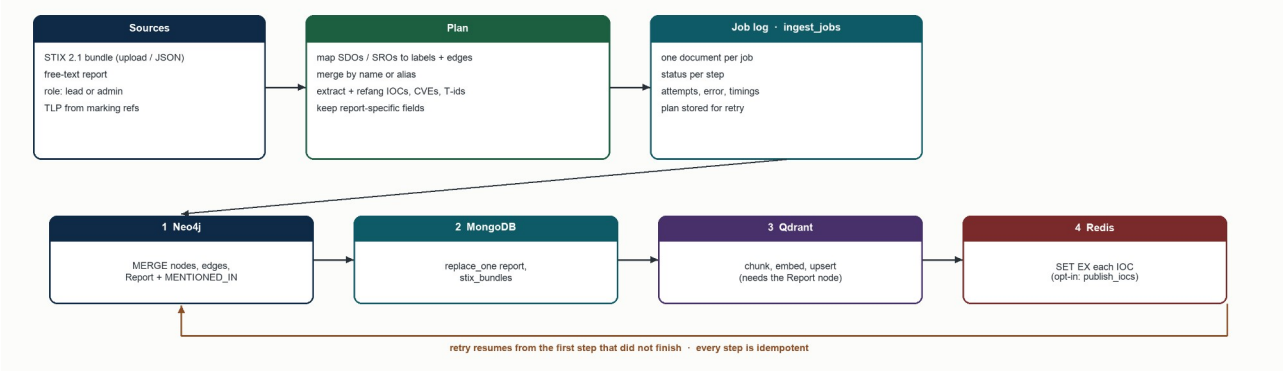


Figure 4. Ingest fan-out with a job log and idempotent retry.

6.3 GraphRAG orchestration (FR5, FR7, NFR4)

Figure 5 traces one question. Entity linking maps names, aliases and IOCs in the question to graph ids. Four channels then retrieve evidence: Qdrant k-NN over chunks with the analyst's TLP as a payload filter; Neo4j expansion of one to three hops from the linked entities, which may end at but never pass through a hub node (degree above 12), so Mimikatz cannot pull in the whole graph; MongoDB hydration of the cited reports, again TLP-checked; and Redis state for every IOC in the

evidence. Templated queries add the flagship findings (shared infrastructure, tool users) as citable edges.

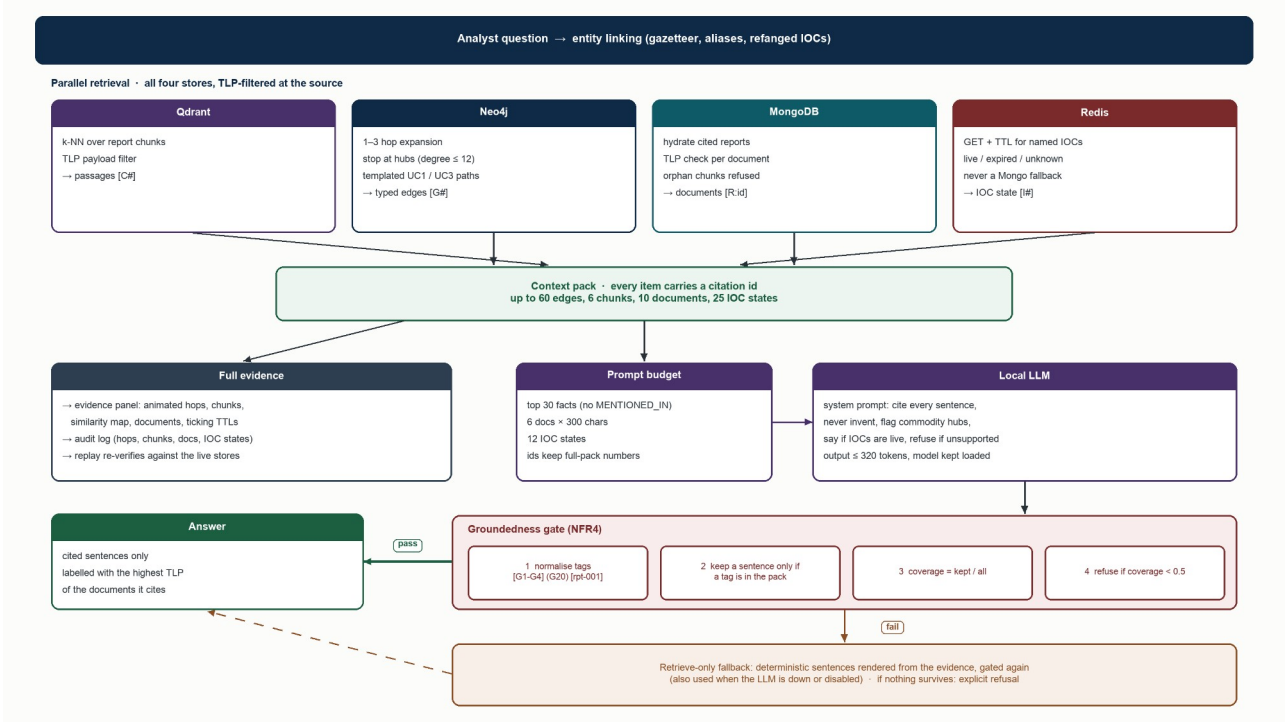


Figure 5. GraphRAG answer path: retrieval, context pack, prompt budget, local LLM and groundedness gate.

Every evidence item receives a citation id — `[G#]` edge, `[C#]` chunk, `[R:id]` report, `[I#]` IOC state. The full pack drives the evidence panel and the audit log, while the LLM receives a trimmed pack (Section 9.8). The groundedness gate splits the answer into sentences, normalises citation variants (`[G1-G4]`, `(G20)`, `[rpt-001]`), keeps a sentence only if one of its tags exists in the pack, and refuses the answer when fewer than half of the sentences survive. A refused LLM answer falls back to a deterministic retrieve-only answer rendered from the same evidence, which is gated again; the same path serves when the LLM is unreachable. The answer inherits the highest TLP of the documents it cites.

6.4 Security and access control (FR11, NFR3, NFR8)

Control	Implementation
Authentication	JWT (HS256, 8-hour expiry); PBKDF2-SHA256 password hashes with 200,000 iterations
Roles	analyst (query), lead (+ publish/revoke IOCs, ingest), admin (+ seed, reindex, delete reports, all audit entries)
TLP clearance	WHITE < GREEN < AMBER < RED (CLEAR → WHITE, AMBER+STRICT → AMBER, unknown → AMBER); enforced on report lists, report detail (403), semantic search, GraphRAG context, answer labels and audit visibility
Enforcement API	separate API-key surface for firewalls, EDR and SIEM; reads Redis only; a miss is never resolved from MongoDB; Redis down → HTTP 503 with blocked: true (fail closed)

Control	Implementation
IP gate	every API request from an address live on the Redis blocklist gets HTTP 403 (health checks excepted); each refusal is logged to MongoDB blocked_requests with expires_at, and a TTL index deletes it after 7 days; X-Forwarded-For is honoured only behind a trusted proxy; a Redis outage lets requests through (fail open) while /api/enforce/* stays fail closed
Audit	every answer stores its hops, chunks, documents and IOC states; replay re-verifies each against the live stores
Data residency	local LLM through Ollama and local embeddings; no LLM or embedding API is called (NFR1). The databases may be local containers or the vendors' hosted services (Section 6.8)

Table 6. Security controls.

6.5 Analyst console

The console has eight pages: GraphRAG console, graph explorer, report browser, IOC blocklist, semantic search, ingest, audit and replay, and operations. Figure 6 shows the GraphRAG console answering acceptance question 4: citation chips link each sentence to its evidence, the commodity-hub caution appears beside the answer, and the evidence panel animates the cited hops. The user manual documents every page.

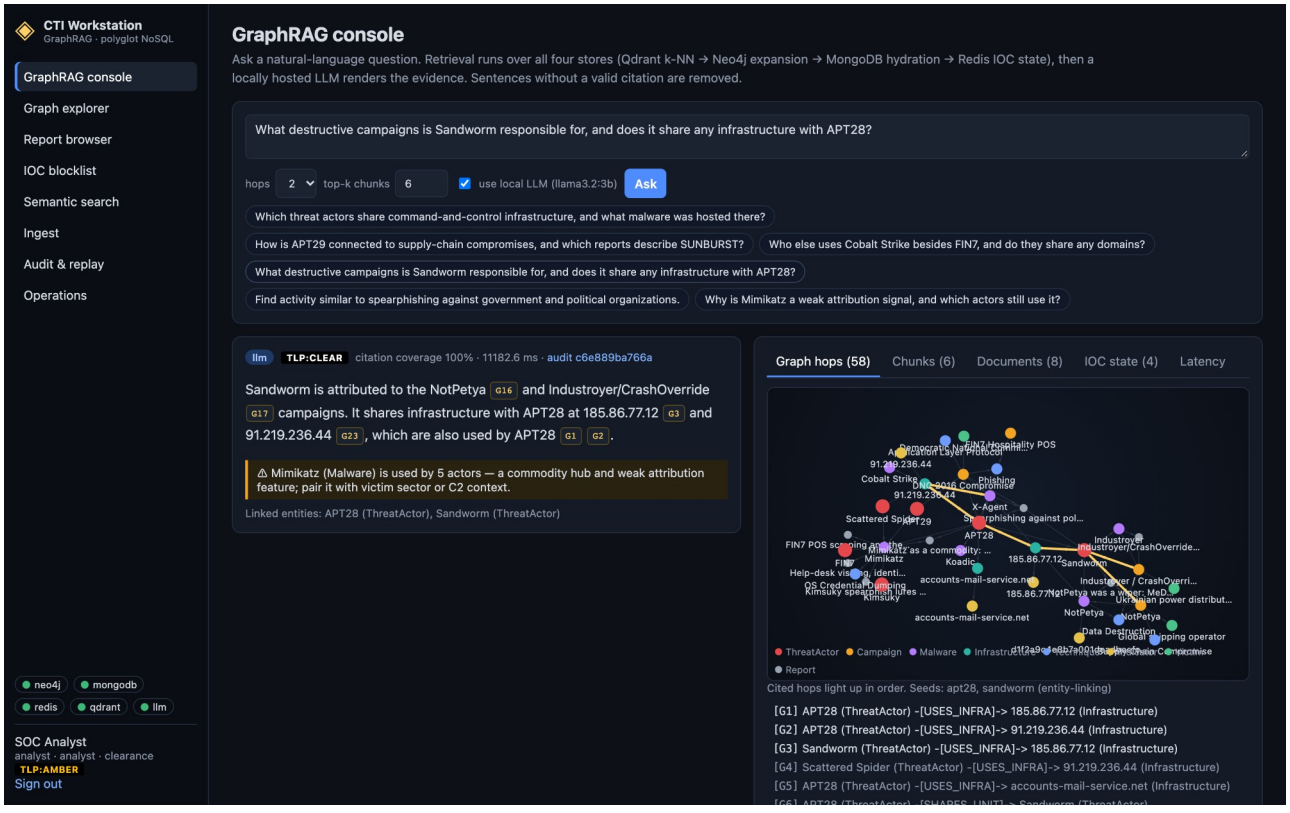


Figure 6. GraphRAG console: cited answer, hub caution and the evidence panel (llama3.2:3b, 100% citation coverage).

6.6 Deployment and operations

`docker compose up -d` starts the four stores; the `app` profile adds the API and an nginx-served console, and the `llm` profile an Ollama container. On first start the API creates the schema and seeds an empty stack. The operations page shows store health, per-store latency percentiles against their

SLOs and the integrity check. Dumps of all four stores and a restore script support reproducibility (NFR5), and GitHub Actions runs the test tiers against fresh service containers on every push.

6.7 The databases in their own consoles

Each store can also be inspected directly in its native tool, independently of the platform (Figure 7, local stack with the seed corpus): Neo4j Browser runs Cypher against the live graph — `CALL db.schema.visualization()` draws the schema of 8 labels and 16 relationship patterns; mongo-express shows the `cti` database's six collections and each report with its own nested fields; Redis Commander shows every `ioc:{type}:{value}` key with its value and a TTL that counts down; and the Qdrant dashboard lists the 25 vector points of `threat_chunks` with their payloads and HNSW settings. `make dbui` starts the two consoles that are not built in, read-only and bound to the local machine; `review3/DATABASE_TOUR.md` gives the queries used in the demonstration.

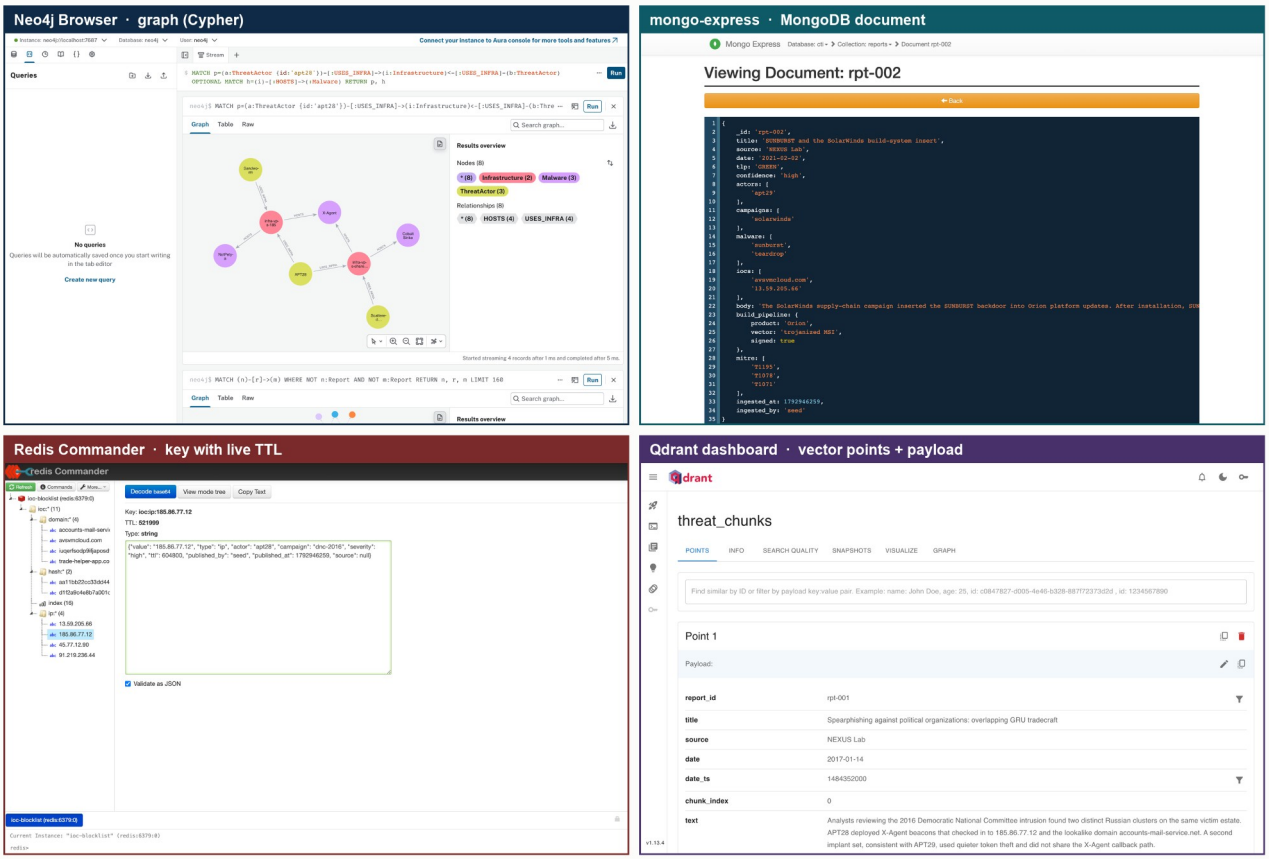


Figure 7. The four NoSQL databases in their own consoles: Neo4j Browser, mongo-express, Redis Commander and the Qdrant dashboard.

6.8 Hosted deployment on the vendors' cloud services

The same code runs unchanged against each database vendor's own hosted service. `.env.cloud` (git-ignored) holds the four connection strings; `make cloud-check` connects read-only and prints each server's hostname and version, `make cloud-seed` and `make cloud-import-feeds` load the data, and `make cloud-api` serves the console from them. Only the databases are hosted: the API, the console and the LLM stay on the analyst's machine, and timeouts are longer for remote stores. Table 7 lists

the deployment as verified on 2026-10-27; Figure 8 shows the Operations page reporting each hosted store.

Store	Service and version	Host	Contents (ping)
Neo4j	Neo4j AuraDB Free, 5.27-aura (enterprise)	9cde3461.databases.neo4j.io	2118 nodes (783 ms)
MongoDB	MongoDB Atlas M0, 8.0.34	cluster0.47ee9jp.mongodb.net	249 reports (168 ms)
Redis	Redis Cloud (free, 30 MB, 100 ops/s), 8.6.2	trains-turquoiseish-inherent-33986.db.redis.io	515 live IOCs (361 ms)
Qdrant	Qdrant Cloud (free, AWS eu-west-1), 1.20.0	3f3fa6c2….eu-west-1-0.aws.cloud.qdrant.io	server: threat_chunks (794 chunks) (824 ms)

Table 7. The four hosted databases. All are free tiers; the project uses well under 1% of each quota.

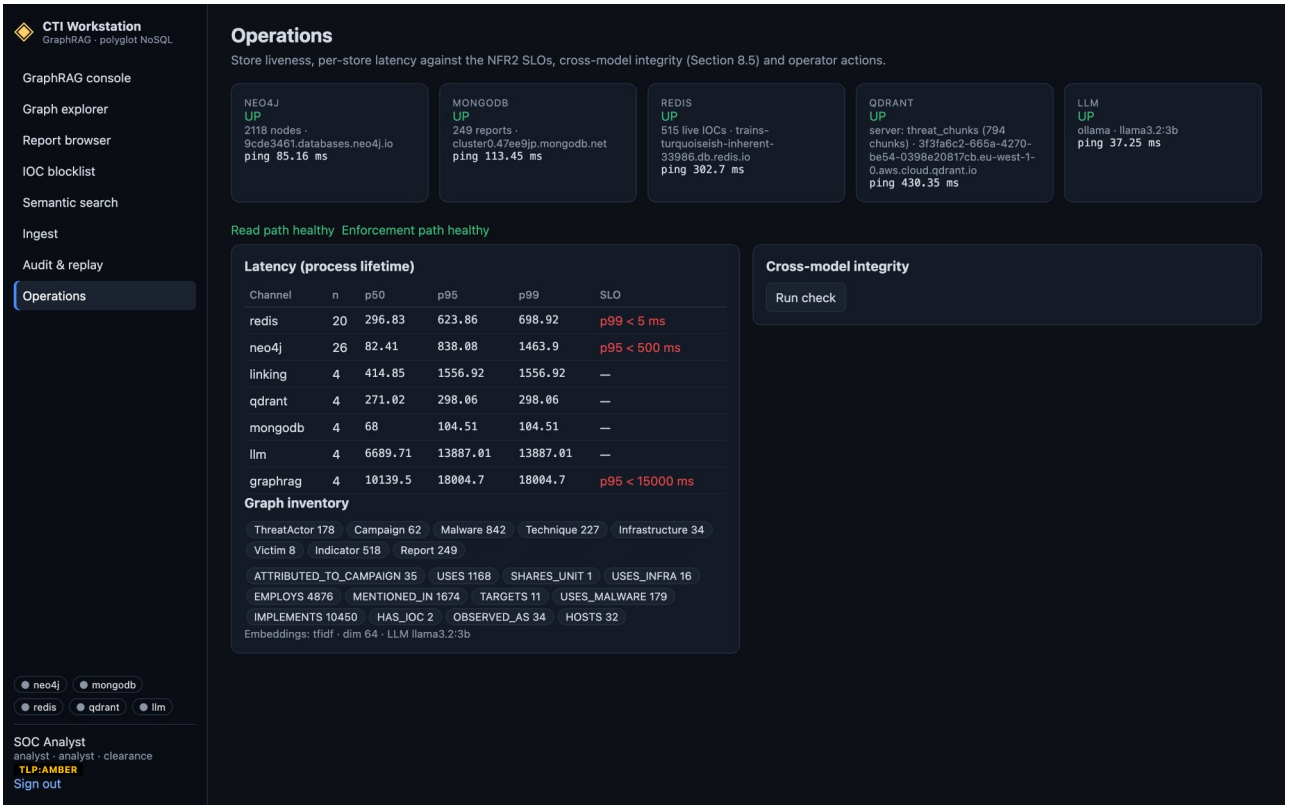


Figure 8. Operations page with the API on the hosted databases: AuraDB, Atlas, Redis Cloud and Qdrant Cloud, their contents and per-store latency.

6.9 Real threat intelligence

`make import-feeds` (`backend/scripts/import_feeds.py`) adds three public feeds that need no account (Table 8). ATT&CK's STIX bundle is mapped onto the existing schema: intrusion sets become ThreatActor nodes, malware and tools Malware, techniques Technique (sub-techniques fold into their parent) and campaigns Campaign, with USES, EMPLOYS, IMPLEMENTS, USES_MALWARE and ATTRIBUTED_TO_CAMPAIGN edges. ATT&CK's APT28, APT29, Sandworm Team, Lazarus Group, FIN7, APT41, Scattered Spider and Kimsuky, and 13 malware families, merge onto the seed corpus's nodes by name and alias instead of duplicating them. Each group and campaign also becomes a MongoDB report written from ATT&CK's own descriptions, which is chunked into Qdrant. Feodo Tracker C2 servers become Infrastructure nodes that HOST

their malware family, and every feed IP becomes an Indicator node and a Redis key whose TTL follows the feed's status (7 days for an online C2, 2–3 days for recent ones, 24 hours for compromised hosts). Writes are batched with UNWIND, and Redis writes are paced under the free plan's 100 operations per second. Names that are ordinary words ("Net", "Silence", "Wiper") are stored with `linkable=false`, so a question links to them only by ATT&CK id. Figure 9 shows a GraphRAG answer over the imported ATT&CK data.

Feed	What is imported	Size
MITRE ATT&CK Enterprise v20.0 (STIX 2.1)	groups, malware and tools, techniques, campaigns and their relationships; one report per group and campaign	178 groups, 842 software, 227 techniques, 57 campaigns, 16,678 relationships, 237 reports
abuse.ch Feodo Tracker	botnet C2 IPs last online since 2025 (QakBot, Emotet), with port, AS, country and status	21 C2 servers, one report
Emerging Threats compromised hosts	IPs of hosts seen compromised and taking part in attacks	482 IPs, one report
Result in the stores	Neo4j 2,118 nodes and 18,478 relationships; MongoDB 249 reports; Qdrant 794 chunks; Redis 515 live IOCs	import: 5 min over the internet

Table 8. Public feeds imported into all four stores.

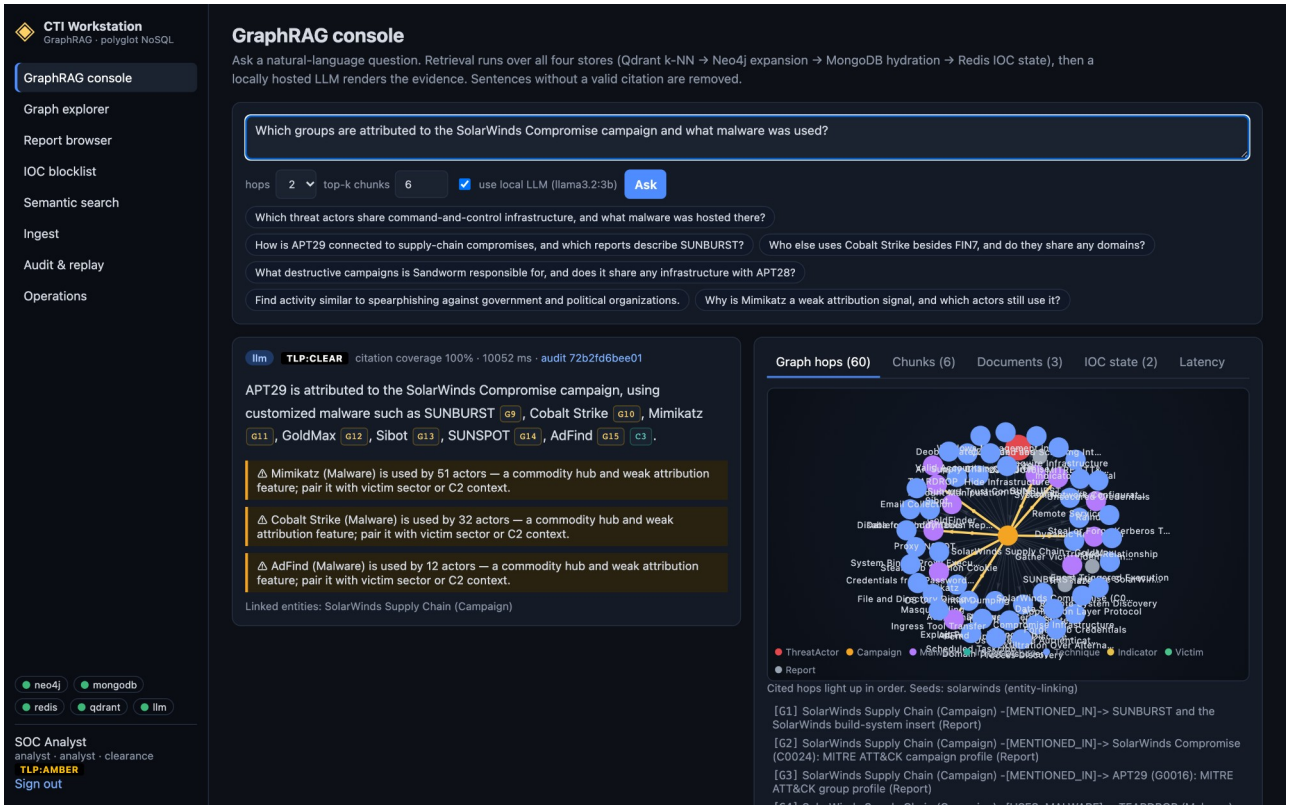


Figure 9. GraphRAG on the hosted databases: ATT&CK's SolarWinds Compromise (C0024) resolves to APT29 and its malware, every sentence cited, with commodity-tool cautions.

7. Innovation and Technical Complexity

7.1 Novel features

- **Four-store GraphRAG with typed citations.** Evidence from a graph, a document store, a vector index and a key–value cache is unified into one context pack where each item carries a store-specific citation id; the console resolves each id back to its store.
- **Groundedness gate with deterministic fallback.** Uncited sentences are removed, the answer is refused below 50% coverage, and a refused answer is replaced by evidence-only sentences rather than an unsupported one.
- **Hub-aware traversal.** Traversals stop at commodity hubs, bounding the evidence (60 edges at every corpus size in Section 9.3), and the answer must state that a commodity tool is a weak attribution signal (UC3).
- **TLP-aware retrieval and answer labelling.** Clearance is applied inside each store query — a Qdrant payload filter, a MongoDB $in, a graph filter — not after generation, and the answer is labelled with the highest TLP it cites.
- **Enforcement plane separate from the read path.** Consumers see only Redis, which fails closed, while the analyst read path degrades to retrieve-only answers when Redis or the LLM is down (NFR8).
- **Replayable answers.** An answer from weeks ago can be re-verified edge by edge, chunk by chunk and IOC by IOC against the current stores.
- **Local AI with a prompt budget.** The LLM sees a ranked, trimmed evidence pack sized for local inference, so a 3-billion-parameter model meets the interactive SLO without a GPU server.
- **Self-measuring system.** An evaluation gate and a benchmark harness are part of the code base; Section 9 shows they found and verified four performance fixes.

7.2 Advanced NoSQL capabilities used

Store	Capabilities beyond basic CRUD
Neo4j	variable-length path patterns with COUNT {} subquery predicates (hub budget); weighted path ranking with reduce(); composite (type, value) uniqueness; UNION-of-labels lookups that turn label-less matches into index seeks; CALL … IN TRANSACTIONS for batched bulk writes; PROFILE-driven tuning
MongoDB	schema-on-read documents with report-specific nested fields; multikey indexes on array fields; explain() plans used to verify index use; idempotent replace_one upserts; collStats for index sizing
Redis	per-key TTL with SET EX; sorted-set expiry index (ZADD, ZRANGEBYSCORE, ZCOUNT); pipelined GET + TTL batches; AOF persistence so TTLs survive restarts
Qdrant	HNSW with tunable search breadth (ef); keyword and integer payload indexes; filtered k-NN; filter-based deletes; exact search used as ground truth for recall

Table 9. Advanced capabilities of each engine used by the platform.

7.3 AI integration

The LLM is used only to render retrieved evidence as prose; it never decides what is retrieved and never writes to a store. It runs locally through Ollama (`llama3.2:3b` by default, `llama3.1:8b` optional [31], [32]) under a system prompt that requires a citation on every sentence, forbids invented entities and offensive content, and requires an exact refusal string when evidence is missing. Embeddings default to a deterministic 64-dimensional TF-IDF + truncated-SVD model, with a neural model (`nomic-embed-text`) available through configuration.

8. Testing and Validation

Tier	Count	What it checks
Unit tests	18	TLP ordering and clearance, password hashing, IOC extraction and refanging, entity linking (including equivalence of the indexed linker with the reference linker), STIX mapping, chunking, the groundedness gate and its citation forms
Integration tests	16	the real API against the live stores: auth and roles, TLP on lists, search and GraphRAG context, publish → enforce → revoke, fail-closed enforcement, LLM-down fallback, audit replay, ingest fan-out, delete cascade, integrity
Evaluation gate	6 questions	gold graph edges and reports, refusals, commodity caution, expiry probe, integrity; exits non-zero on any failure
Benchmarks	6 experiments	scalability, load, Redis, MongoDB and Neo4j index ablations, Qdrant recall (Section 9)
Continuous integration	every push	unit + integration + evaluation gate on fresh Neo4j, MongoDB, Redis and Qdrant containers; frontend build

Table 10. Test tiers. Integration tests remove everything they write, so they run safely against the demo stack.

8.1 Acceptance tests

The six Appendix A questions of Review I are the acceptance tests. Each must retrieve specified gold edges and gold reports. Table 11 shows the final run with the default model.

Question	Mode	Gold edges	Gold reports	Coverage	Latency
Which threat actors share command-and-control infrastructure, and what malware was hosted there?	LLM	2/2	1/1	0.50	7.8 s
How is APT29 connected to supply-chain compromises, and which reports describe SUNBURST?	retrieve-only (gate fallback)	1/1	1/1	1.00	9.5 s
Who else uses Cobalt Strike besides FIN7, and do they share any domains?	LLM	2/2	1/1	1.00	6.4 s
What destructive campaigns is Sandworm responsible for, and does it share any infrastructure with APT28?	LLM	2/2	1/1	1.00	6.1 s
Find activity similar to spearphishing against government and political organizations.	LLM	0/0	1/1	0.67	9.2 s
Why is Mimikatz a weak attribution signal, and which actors still use it?	LLM	2/2	1/1	0.60	9.4 s

Table 11. Acceptance results (2026-10-25, llama3.2:3b). Gold edge recall 1.00, gold report recall 1.00, mean citation coverage 0.79.

Every question retrieved all of its gold evidence and none was refused. In question 2 the model's draft fell below the coverage threshold and the gate replaced it with the deterministic evidence answer — the intended behaviour, not a failure. Question 6 carries the commodity-hub caution required by UC3. The same questions in retrieve-only mode, as run in CI, reach coverage 1.00 at about 50 ms per question.

8.2 Verification on the hosted databases

The four checks below were run against AuraDB, Atlas, Redis Cloud and Qdrant Cloud after the real feeds were loaded (Table 12). Figure 10 shows the refusal log in the console and Figure 11 the blocking key read directly from Redis Cloud.

Check	Result
Connection to each database	`make cloud-check`: all four reachable over TLS — Neo4j AuraDB Free 5.27-aura, MongoDB Atlas M0 8.0.34, Redis Cloud 8.6.2, Qdrant Cloud 1.20.0
Data stored in each database	cross-store integrity check passes on the hosted stores: 249 MongoDB reports = 249 Report nodes = 249 reports with Qdrant chunks; 515 live Redis IOCs, each traceable to an Indicator node or a report
GraphRAG retrieves the data	acceptance questions: gold edge recall 1.00, gold report recall 1.00, citation coverage 0.87; real-data questions answered from ATT&CK and Feodo documents (feed-feodo, attack-C0024, attack-G0034)
Blocking by client IP	request from 50.16.16.211 (abuse.ch Feodo Tracker QakBot C2, severity critical, TTL 7 days) → HTTP 403 on every route, health check 200; each refusal logged in Atlas with expires_at 7 days ahead
TTL on the refusal log	Atlas index expires_at_1 with expireAfterSeconds 0; an already-expired entry was deleted by MongoDB's TTL monitor after 36 s
TTL on the block itself	an IP published with a 45 s TTL was refused, then admitted again 47 s later when Redis expired the key
Integration tests	16/16 pass against the hosted stores (47 s)

Table 12. Verification on the hosted databases (2026-10-27).

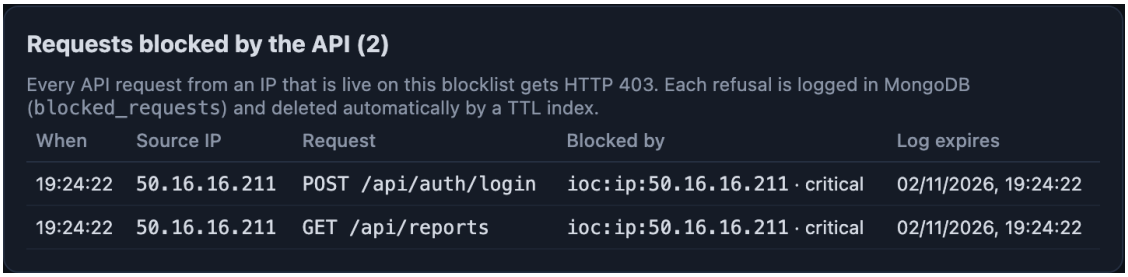


Figure 10. IOC blocklist page: API requests from the QakBot C2 address 50.16.16.211 refused, with the time each log entry expires.

```
DBSIZE
516
ZCOUNT ioc:index -inf +inf
515
GET ioc:ip:50.16.16.211
"{\"value\": \"50.16.16.211\", \"type\": \"ip\", \"actor\": null, \"campaign\": null, \"severity\": \"critical\", \"ttl\": 604800, \"published_by\": \"import-
feeds\", \"published_at\": 1793042268, \"source\": \"abuse.ch Feodo Tracker\", \"malware\": \"QakBot\"}"
TTL ioc:ip:50.16.16.211
603771
GET ioc:ip:34.204.119.63
"{\"value\": \"34.204.119.63\", \"type\": \"ip\", \"actor\": null, \"campaign\": null, \"severity\": \"high\", \"ttl\": 259200, \"published_by\": \"import-
feeds\", \"published_at\": 1793042268, \"source\": \"abuse.ch Feodo Tracker\", \"malware\": \"QakBot\"}"
TTL ioc:ip:34.204.119.63
258166
```

Figure 11. Redis Commander connected to Redis Cloud: blocklist keys of two Feodo Tracker QakBot C2 servers and their remaining TTL in seconds.

Correctness is unchanged, but latency now includes the internet: a Redis lookup takes 779 ms at p99 (local 1.16 ms) and GraphRAG 18.3 s at p95 (local 12.7 s), so the Redis and GraphRAG targets of NFR2, set for co-located stores, are not met on free tiers in other regions. Graph traversals stay within their 500 ms target (3-hop p95 457 ms).

9. Performance Evaluation

9.1 Method

Benchmarks run with `make bench` against a throwaway stack (`docker-compose.bench.yml`) on alternate ports, so synthetic data never reaches the demo stores; the demo stack is paused for the run. Each latency figure is a client-side percentile over repeated calls after warm-up (30–2,000 samples per measurement), taken through the same Python functions the API uses. To scale the corpus, the seed corpus is cloned 10×–200× through the production seed loader: clones receive new ids, names and infrastructure values from the RFC 2544 benchmarking range, one cross-clone infrastructure edge per actor, and they share the ATT&CK techniques and commodity tools, so hub degree grows with scale as it would in practice. Index experiments use dedicated synthetic collections. LLM measurements come from `make eval` on the demo stack.

Host	Apple M3 Pro, 18 GB RAM, macOS
Docker VM	2 vCPU, 3.8 GB shared by all containers
Engines	Neo4j 5.26.31 · MongoDB 7.0.43 · Redis 7.4.11 · Qdrant 1.13.4
Runtime	Python 3.11.7, FastAPI, one Uvicorn worker; Ollama on the host GPU (Metal)
Corpus scales	1× = 87 nodes / 12 reports; 10× = 762 nodes / 120 reports; 50× = 3,762 nodes / 600 reports; 100× = 7,512 nodes / 1,200 reports; 200× = 15,012 nodes / 2,400 reports

Table 13. Benchmark environment.

Threats to validity. All engines share two virtual CPUs, so absolute numbers are conservative for a server deployment but contention is real. The scaled corpus is synthetic and repetitive, which favours caches; the index experiments therefore use independent random data. Load is generated on the same host as the server.

9.2 Service-level objectives (NFR2)

Metric	Target	Measured	Result
Redis blocklist GET p99	< 5 ms	1.08 ms (500 calls); 0.534 ms at 500,000 keys	met
Neo4j 1 / 2 / 3-hop p95	< 500 ms	12.39 / 35.52 / 15.73 ms	met
Neo4j 2-hop p95 at 200×	< 500 ms	10.8 ms	met
GraphRAG end-to-end p95 (with LLM)	< 15 s	9.5 s (llama3.2:3b)	met
GraphRAG retrieval p95 at 200× (no LLM)	—	185 ms	within budget

Table 14. Service-level objectives.

9.3 Scalability from 1× to 200×

Scale	Nodes	Relationships	Reports	Chunks	IOCs	Load time (all stores)
1×	87	162	12	25	15	1.5 s
10×	762	1,665	120	250	150	4.0 s

Scale	Nodes	Relationships	Reports	Chunks	IOCs	Load time (all stores)
50×	3,762	8,345	600	1,250	750	15.8 s
100×	7,512	16,695	1,200	2,500	1,500	27.5 s
200×	15,012	33,395	2,400	5,000	3,000	54.5 s

Table 15. Corpus at each scale, loaded through the production seed path.

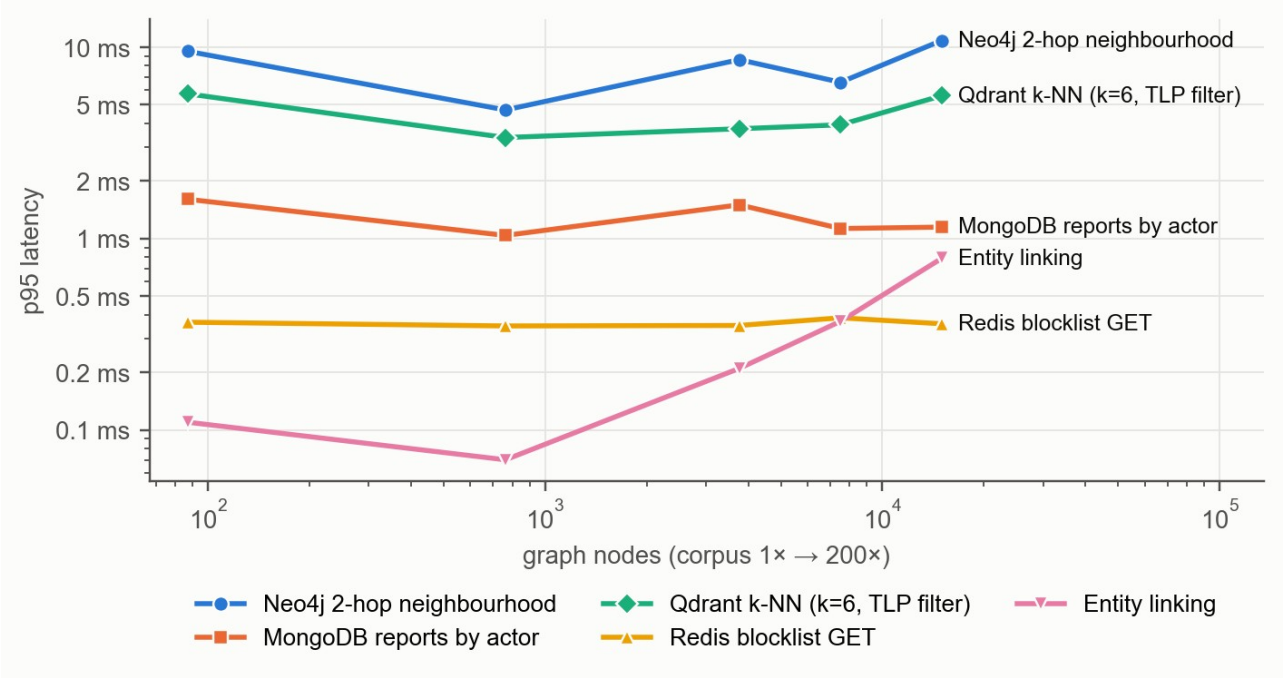


Figure 12. p95 latency of each store's GraphRAG query as the corpus grows 200× (after the fixes of Section 9.4).

Store-level latency is essentially flat across a 170-fold increase in graph size. A 2-hop neighbourhood stays near 9.51 ms–10.8 ms because traversal cost depends on the local neighbourhood, not on graph size (index-free adjacency), and the hub budget keeps the evidence at 60 edges and 10 documents at every scale. MongoDB reads by actor stay near 1.15 ms through the multikey index, Qdrant filtered k-NN near 5.58 ms, and Redis GET near 0.36 ms. Entity-linking p95 rises from 0.11 ms to 0.79 ms because a name such as APT28 has 200 near-duplicate clones to verify — still below a millisecond.

9.4 Bottlenecks found and fixed

The first scaling run did not look like Figure 12. GraphRAG retrieval grew roughly linearly with corpus size — median 26.8 ms at 1× to 675 ms at 200×, p95 14.7 s — and ingest throughput fell from 20.4 to 1.5 reports per second. Per-channel timing and Neo4j PROFILE output traced this to four defects, none visible on the 87-node seed corpus:

Defect	Cause	Fix
Linear entity linking	one regular-expression search per gazetteer surface form for every question and every ingest (≈30,000 at 200×)	inverted index from tokens and dotted runs to surface forms; candidates verified with the original word-boundary rule; a unit test proves identical results [39]

Defect	Cause	Fix
Unbounded global traversal + N+1 lookups	questions naming no actor listed every infrastructure-sharing pair, then fetched each missing node with a label-less MATCH (a full scan of all nodes, once per node)	LIMIT 25 ordered by shared-report evidence; one batched lookup via a UNION of labelled index seeks; an index on Indicator.id
Whole-graph join on ingest	every ingest re-linked OBSERVED_AS across all Infrastructure × Indicator pairs and invalidated the gazetteer	join restricted to the plan's values; gazetteer invalidated only when a job adds graph entities
Thread-unsafe vector client under load	one Qdrant REST client shared by FastAPI's worker threads: under 16 concurrent clients a socket was closed under another thread's read (HTTP 500)	one Qdrant client per worker thread; gazetteer refresh behind a lock

Table 16. Scalability defects exposed by the benchmark and their fixes.

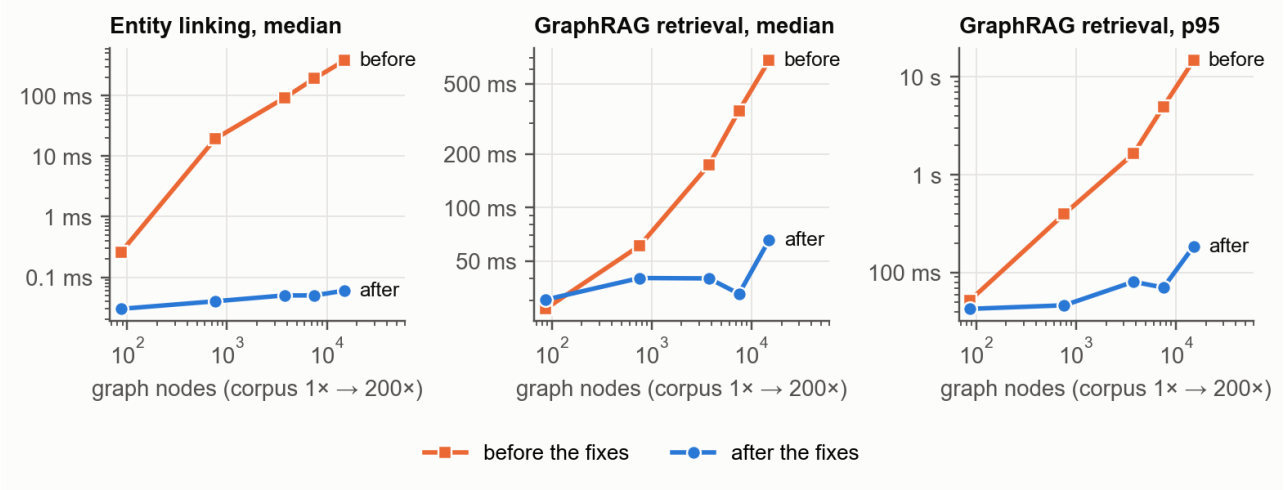


Figure 13. Entity linking and GraphRAG retrieval latency before and after the fixes, 1× to 200×.

At 200× the fixes reduce entity linking from 379 ms to 0.06 ms (median), GraphRAG retrieval from 675 ms to 65.4 ms (median) and from 14.7 s to 185 ms (p95), and raise ingest throughput from 1.5 to 31.6 reports per second (Figure 14). The full scale experiment now runs in 123.4 s instead of 331.8 s.

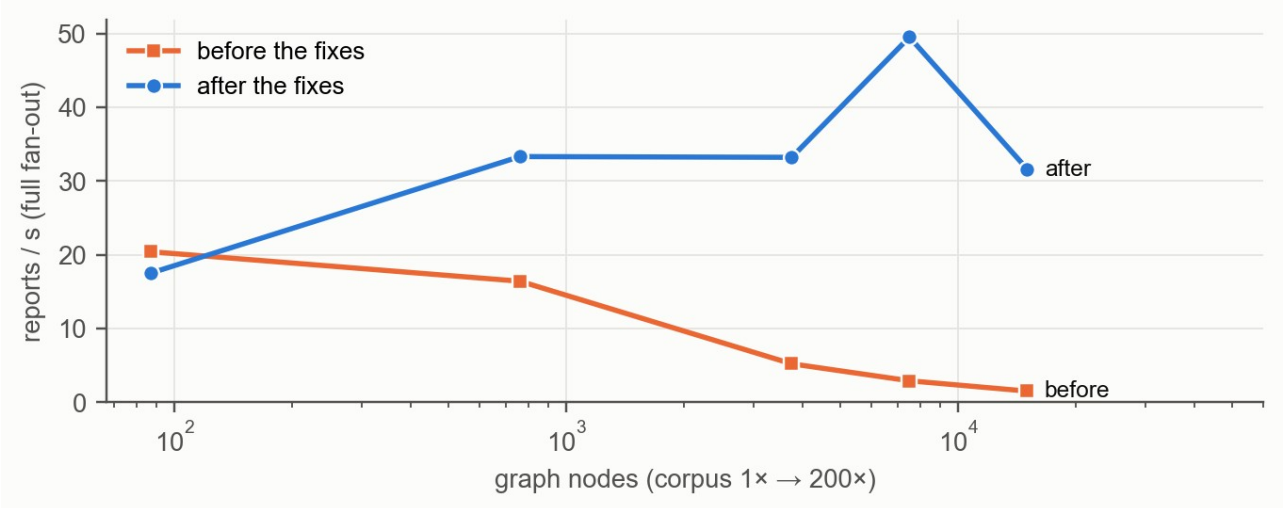


Figure 14. Ingest throughput through the full four-store fan-out, before and after the fixes.

9.5 Indexing

Each store's indexes were ablated on dedicated data: 200,000 synthetic reports in MongoDB and 100,000 hosts in Neo4j. Figure 15 and Table 17 show latency together with the work the engine reports — documents and keys examined from MongoDB `explain()`, database hits from Neo4j `PROFILE`.

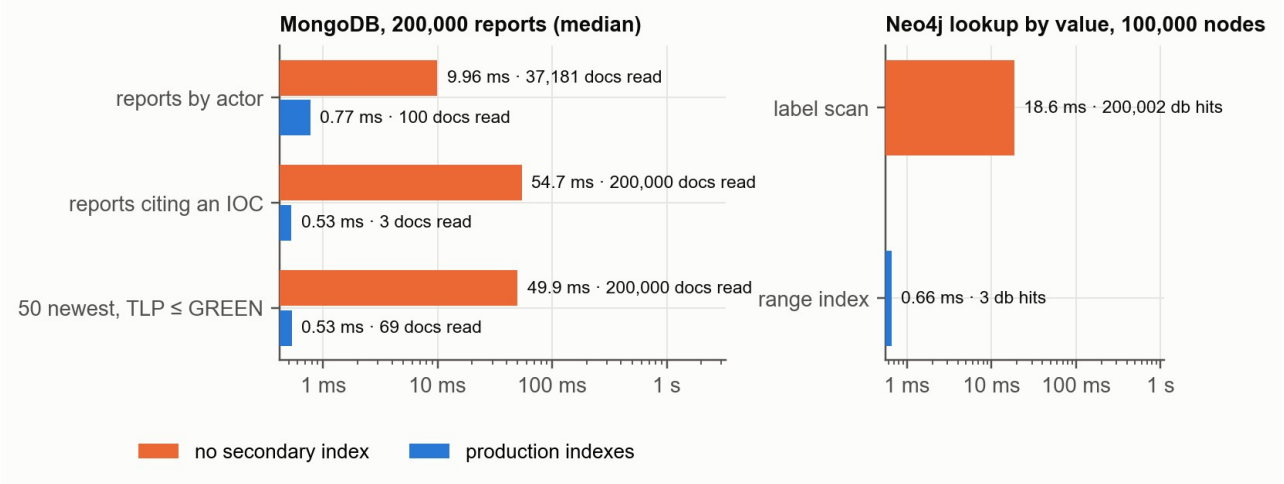


Figure 15. Index ablation: MongoDB report queries and Neo4j property lookup, without and with indexes (median latency).

Query	Plan without → with	Docs examined	Median latency	Speed-up
reports by actor (limit 100)	COLLSCAN → IXSCAN	37,181 → 100	9.96 ms → 0.77 ms	13×
reports citing an IOC	COLLSCAN → IXSCAN	200,000 → 3	54.7 ms → 0.53 ms	103×
50 newest at TLP ≤ GREEN	COLLSCAN → IXSCAN	200,000 → 69	49.9 ms → 0.53 ms	94×
Neo4j host by value	NodeByLabelScan → NodeIndexSeek	200,002 → 3 db hits	18.6 ms → 0.66 ms	28×

Table 17. Index ablation results.

Without secondary indexes MongoDB scans the collection (COLLSCAN) and reads up to every document; the multikey indexes reduce this to the matching documents. The newest-first TLP query reads 69 documents through the date index and 50 with a compound (tlp, date) index — a small further gain we record but do not need at this scale. The production indexes cost 14.0 MB for 44 MB of data and build in 0.95 s. In Neo4j, a label scan touches every node; the range index turns the lookup into a seek with 3 database hits.

9.6 Key–value enforcement plane

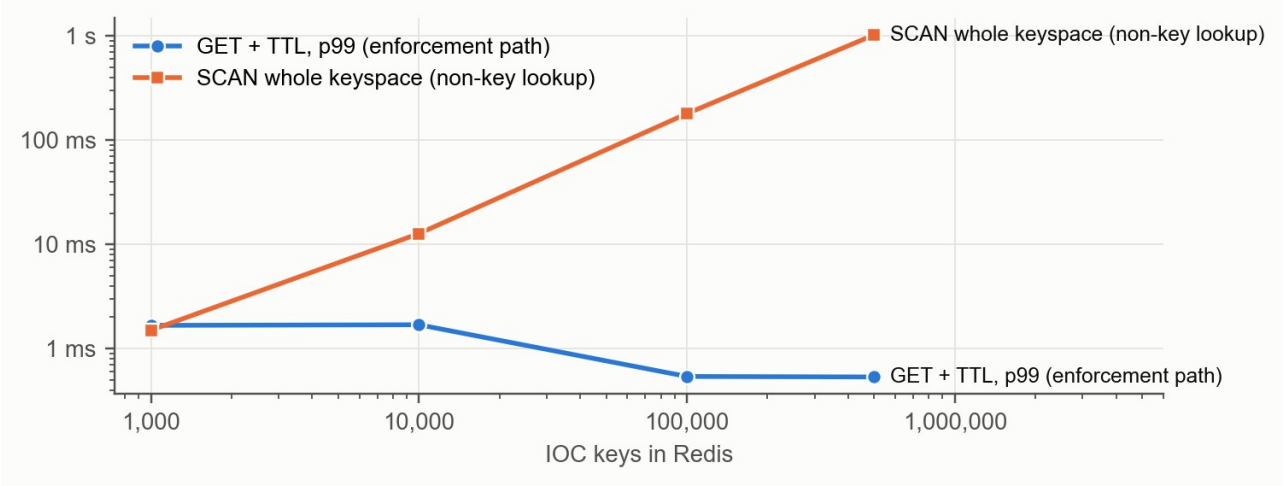


Figure 16. Redis: blocklist lookup p99 against a full keyspace scan as the number of IOC keys grows to 500,000.

The enforcement lookup (pipelined GET + TTL) stays at 0.29 ms median and 0.53 ms p99 at 500,000 keys, while any lookup that is not by key — such as finding IOCs by actor — needs a full SCAN that grows linearly to 1.0 s. This is why the design never queries Redis by attribute (NFR3) and keeps attribute queries in MongoDB and Neo4j. Memory grows to 191.6 MB at 500,000 keys (about 402 bytes per IOC including the expiry index).

9.7 Vector search: HNSW against exact search

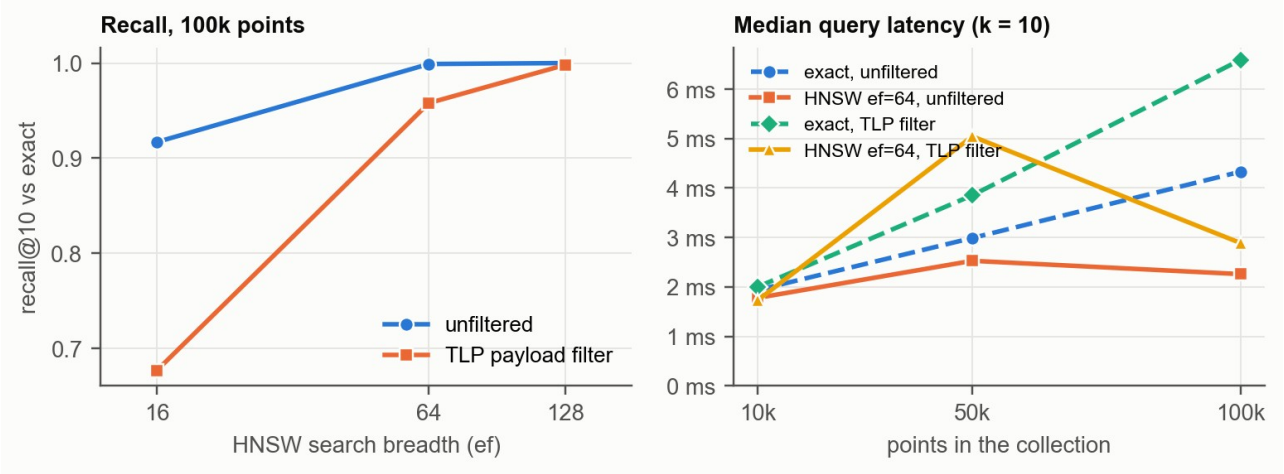


Figure 17. Qdrant: recall@10 of HNSW as search breadth grows, and median latency of HNSW and exact search as the collection grows.

Points	Exact (unfiltered)	HNSW ef = 64	Recall@10 ef = 64	Recall@10 ef = 128 (TLP filter)
10,000	1.94 ms	1.78 ms	1.000	1.000
50,000	2.99 ms	2.53 ms	1.000	1.000
100,000	4.33 ms	2.26 ms	0.999	0.998

Table 18. HNSW against exact search on 64-dimensional clustered vectors (100 queries, k = 10).

Exact search grows linearly with the collection (1.94 ms → 4.33 ms) while HNSW stays near 2.26 ms with recall@10 of 0.999 at ef = 64. Filtering by TLP needs a wider search: at 100,000 points recall

is 0.68 at ef = 16 but 0.998 at ef = 128. The platform's own collection (25 chunks, 5,000 at 200×) is below Qdrant's indexing threshold, so it is searched exactly — the optimal choice at that size.

9.8 Concurrency

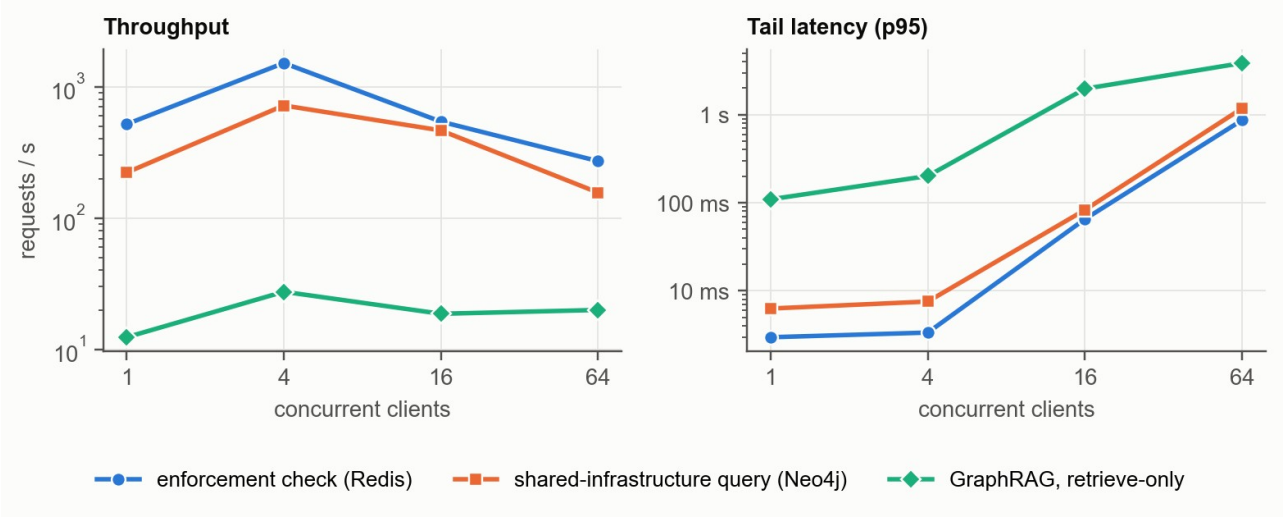


Figure 18. API throughput and p95 latency from 1 to 64 concurrent clients (200× corpus, one Uvicorn worker).

A single API worker peaks at 1,512 enforcement checks per second (4 clients) and 27.5 GraphRAG retrievals per second, with no errors at any level after the thread-safety fix. Beyond four clients throughput falls and tail latency rises sharply: the worker is bound by the Python interpreter lock and the two virtual CPUs it shares with the stores, so requests queue. Throughput therefore scales by adding Uvicorn workers or API replicas behind a load balancer — the stores are not the limit — and a deployment on dedicated cores would move the knee further out.

9.9 LLM latency

The GraphRAG SLO is the only one that depends on the language model. Profiling one call showed that with the full evidence pack (17,663 characters, 4,991 tokens) `llama3.1:8b` spent 17 s evaluating the prompt and 7.4 s generating 117 tokens. A prompt budget — the top 30 non-MENTIONED_IN facts, six documents of 300 characters and 12 IOC states, about half the characters — plus an output cap and keep-alive brought `llama3.1` to 21–27 s, and `llama3.2:3b` to 9.5 s p95 (Figure 19). Keeping the most relevant evidence also follows the observation that models use long contexts poorly [36].

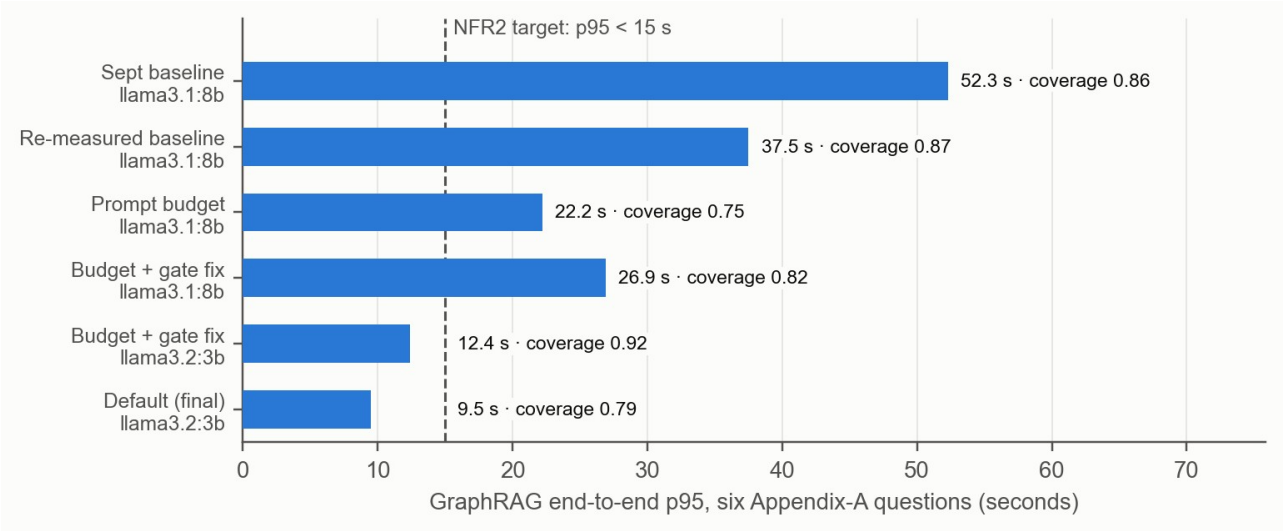


Figure 19. GraphRAG end-to-end p95 across measured configurations, with mean citation coverage (six acceptance questions).

The smaller model is the default because it meets the SLO with full gold recall; `llama3.1` gives fuller prose and remains one setting away (`OLLAMA_MODEL`). The groundedness-gate fix of this review matters here: before it, sentences such as "Sandworm is attributed to NotPetya (G20)" were discarded for using parentheses, lowering coverage for both models.

9.10 Summary

- Every NFR2 objective is met, including GraphRAG end-to-end p95 9.5 s < 15 s.
- Store-level queries stay flat from 87 to 15,012 nodes; GraphRAG retrieval p95 at 200× is 185 ms after the fixes.
- Indexes give 103× (MongoDB, IOC lookup) and 28× (Neo4j) speed-ups and cut examined records by up to five orders of magnitude.
- Redis lookups are independent of key count up to 500,000 keys; HNSW keeps recall@10 ≥ 0.999 at half the latency of exact search at 100,000 points.
- The benchmark found four defects invisible at seed scale; all are fixed and covered by tests or re-measurement.

10. Requirement Traceability

Req	Requirement	Implementation	Evidence
FR1	Ingest STIX 2.1 and free text, fan-out	ingest.py plans, job log, retry	unit + integration tests
FR2	Multi-hop graph queries	graph.py: shared infrastructure, tooling, victims, paths	acceptance Q1, Q3, Q4
FR3	O(1) blocklist with TTL, export	blocklist.py: SET EX, ZSET index; /enforce/*	Section 9.6; integration
FR4	Semantic search with filters	vectors.search: TLP, actor, date payload filters	integration; Section 9.7
FR5	GraphRAG Q&A on a local LLM	graphrag.ask, Ollama /api/chat	Table 11
FR6	Hydration of reports	documents.hydrate, GET /api/reports/{id}	integration
FR7	Evidence UI	GraphRAG evidence panel	Figure 6
FR8	Corpus and ongoing ingest	seed.py, data.py, auto-seed	CI first start
FR9	Health and SLOs	stores.health, metrics.py, Operations page	Section 9.2
FR10	Replay and audit	save_audit, replay	integration: hops re-verified
FR11	AuthN and TLP	security.py; TLP in every store query	integration (junior)
FR12	Publish and revoke IOCs	POST/DELETE /api/blocklist (lead)	integration
NFR1	Data residency	local Ollama and embeddings	no LLM or embedding API calls
NFR2	Interactive latency	prompt budget, indexes, fixes of 9.4	Section 9
NFR3	Store isolation	enforcement reads Redis only	integration; 9.6
NFR4	Groundedness	groundedness gate, refusal, fallback	unit tests; Table 11
NFR5	Reproducibility	compose, pinned dependencies, versioned schema, dumps, CI	CI from empty stores
NFR6	Ethics and safety	public corpus, lab IOCs, system prompt	—
NFR7	Usability	UC1–UC4 inside the console	user manual, demo
NFR8	Availability	retrieve-only when LLM/Redis down; fail closed	integration tests

Table 19. Requirement traceability. All functional and non-functional requirements are met.

Gap	Review I observation	Closed by
G1	one engine forced to serve four workloads	four engines with closed operation sets (Table 2); measured in Section 9
G2	sharing platforms lack a query-native graph with enforcement state	Neo4j graph + Redis enforcement plane + cited Q&A
G3	knowledge graphs lack TTL cache and vectors	Redis and Qdrant beside Neo4j, joined by shared keys
G4	RAG over CTI is under-constrained	four-channel GraphRAG with a groundedness gate
G5	answers cannot be audited	evidence panel, audit log and replay

Table 20. Review I gaps and how the final system closes them.

11. Limitations and Future Work

- **Single-node deployment.** All stores run as single instances; clustering Neo4j, MongoDB replica sets and Redis replication are configuration work, not design changes.

- **One API worker.** Section 9.8 shows the knee at four concurrent clients on two virtual CPUs; production would run several workers or replicas.
- **Corpus.** Twelve curated reports exercise every mechanism and the real feeds add ATT&CK and two IP feeds; the 200× scaling is synthetic. A TAXII connector with scheduled refresh would keep the feeds current without re-running the import.
- **Hosted latency.** On free tiers in other regions, Redis and GraphRAG miss their co-located latency targets (Section 8.2). Paid tiers in the analyst's region, or the local stack, meet them.
- **Model quality versus latency.** `llama3.2:3b` meets the SLO but writes terser answers than `llama3.1:8b`; streaming the answer with the gate applied on completion would let the larger model feel interactive.
- **Embeddings.** The default TF-IDF + SVD model is deterministic and offline but weaker than neural embeddings; `nomic-embed-text` is supported and should become the default once download size is acceptable for the target environment.
- **Demo-grade secrets.** The JWT secret and consumer key in `.env.example` must be replaced outside a lab.

12. Conclusion

The platform shows that CTI is best served by a polyglot design in which each NoSQL model does what it is best at, and that GraphRAG over such a design can be both useful and accountable. Relationships live in Neo4j, reports in MongoDB, live indicators in Redis and narrative similarity in Qdrant; a local LLM turns their combined evidence into answers whose every sentence can be traced and replayed. Review III completed the system, verified it with 34 automated tests and continuous integration, and measured it: all latency objectives are met, store-level queries remain flat across a 200-fold corpus increase, and the benchmark harness proved its worth by exposing and confirming the fix of four defects that would have surfaced only in production.

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Appendix A. Reproducing the Results

All results in this report can be regenerated from the repository. The demo stack and the benchmark stack use different ports and volumes.

```
make infra && make install          # four stores, Python and Node dependencies
make api                            # FastAPI on :8000 (seeds empty stores)
make web                            # console on :5173
ollama pull llama3.2:3b             # local model (default)
make test                           # unit tests
make test-integration               # API against the live stores
make eval-check                     # acceptance questions + gates  ->
backend/eval_report.json
make import-feeds                   # real feeds: MITRE ATT&CK, abuse.ch Feodo
Tracker, Emerging Threats
make cloud-check && make cloud-seed && make cloud-import-feeds && make cloud-api   #
hosted databases
docker compose --profile app stop   # pause the demo stack before benchmarking
make bench                          # throwaway stack ->
review3/performance/benchmark_results.json
python review3/make_charts.py       # charts       (pip install matplotlib==3.9.2)
python review3/generate_figures.py  # diagrams     (pip install pillow)
node review3/generate_report.js     # this report  (npm install in review3/,
LibreOffice for PDF)
```

The raw results are in `review3/performance/`: `benchmark_results.json` (after the fixes), `benchmark_baseline_before_fixes.json`, the evaluation runs (including `eval_real_data_local.json` and `eval_real_data_cloud.json`), `cloud_verification.json` and `llm_latency_runs.json`, which records the provenance of every LLM measurement in Figure 19.